

French A1 — Week 2 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 2

Theme: Describing People

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 2 adds two things to your French toolkit:

- **Avoir** (to have) — the second essential French verb. You will use it for age (*J'ai trente ans*) and for describing physical features (*J'ai les cheveux bruns*, *J'ai les yeux verts*).
- **Adjective agreement** — in French, adjectives change their ending to match the gender of the noun they describe. *Il est grand*. *Elle est grande*. This week you will start building that habit.

By the end of Week 2, you will be able to describe what someone looks like and what their personality is like. That is a real and useful thing to be able to do in French.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 2

By the end of Session 4, you should be able to say something like:

J'ai quarante ans. J'ai les cheveux bruns et courts. J'ai les yeux noisette. Je suis de taille moyenne. Je suis assez patient et parfois impatient.

And describe someone else:

C'est ma sœur. Elle a trente-cinq ans. Elle a les cheveux blonds et longs. Elle a les yeux bleus. Elle est grande. Elle est très drôle et très travailleuse.

You will also know how to ask: *Tu as quel âge ?* and *Il/Elle a les yeux de quelle couleur ?*

One Thing That Surprises Students This Week

French says "I have thirty years" — not "I am thirty years old." So:

- In English: I am thirty.
- In French: *J'ai trente ans*. (Literally: "I have thirty years.")

This trips everyone up at first. After you say it a dozen times, it starts to feel natural.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 3 — before Session 4:

1. **Say avoir from memory.** *j'ai, tu as, il/elle a, nous avons, vous avez, ils/elles ont*. Say it three times, then cover the page and say it one more time.
2. **Say your description out loud.** Your four sentences from the homework — say them without your notes at least once.
3. **Practice saying someone else's description.** Choose one person and say three sentences about them — hair, eyes, height.

After Session 4 — before Session 5:

1. **Review the adjective agreement patterns.** The main one to know cold: add -e for feminine. *grand* → *grande*, *patient* → *patiente*.
 2. **Finish your written description** from the Session 4 homework.
 3. **Check your agreement.** Go back through any description you wrote and verify each adjective ends correctly for the gender of the person you are describing.
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A Note on Adjective Agreement

French adjective agreement can feel like extra work. Here is why it is worth learning correctly from the start: if you build the habit now, it becomes automatic. If you skip it, you will be correcting the same errors in Week 10.

The good news: you do not need to memorize every irregular pattern this week. Focus on the regular pattern (-e for feminine) and three irregular ones (*sérieux* → *sérieuse*, *sportif* → *sportive*, *gentil* → *gentille*). The rest you will absorb over time.

Mistakes are expected. Your instructor will correct agreement errors consistently — that is how the habit forms.

Vocabulary to Know Before Week 3

You will find the full Week 2 vocabulary list in your Week 2 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 5 are:

- All six forms of *avoir* from memory
 - Core physical description phrases: *J'ai les cheveux...*, *J'ai les yeux...*, *Je suis...*
 - 6–8 personality adjectives with their feminine forms
 - The rule: add -e for feminine; adjectives already ending in -e do not change
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